

Miya Zhao

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EDUCATION

Yale University *B.S. Statistics and Data Science & Certificate in Programming*

Aug 2023 - May 2027

- *Coursework:* Data Exploration & Analysis, Linear Models, Probability Theory, Theory of Statistics, Data Analysis, Language & Computation, Social Psychology, Research Inquiry & Presentation

London School of Economics and Political Science

June 2025 - Aug 2025

- *Coursework:* Computational Methods in Financial Mathematics, Introduction to Data Science & Machine Learning

PROJECTS

Yale-Maps (In Development)

Sep 2025 – Present

Creator | Product Lead & Developer | Vite, React, Mapbox GL JS, Git

- Identified fragmented campus booking and navigation systems as frequent issue; proposed a centralized, map-based solution to improve access to study spaces, safety resources, and transit
- Defined product scope and feature order, designed the user flow, and built a working map MVP showing room availability, AED locations, and transit routes

EXPERIENCE

Yale International Genetically Engineered Machine (iGEM) — Farren Isaacs Lab

Dec 2023 – Present

President | Wet Lab Lead | Student Researcher

- Led a cross-functional research team to develop a novel protein functionalization approach using non-standard amino acids, aligning technical development with therapeutic use cases of L-asparaginase, a pediatric chemotherapy
- Guided Yale to its **first Gold Medal in 15 years** at the 2025 Annual iGEM Jamboree in Paris
- Designed and launched a global human-practices initiative on science funding and public trust in synthetic biology, engaging stakeholders across 4 continents and 7 countries
- Managed **\$48K+ budget** and secured **\$10K+ in in-kind industry partnerships** (Abcam, NEB, Twist, IDT) through pitching and negotiation
- Built a logistic-regression-based modeling tool to optimize experimental workflows and reduce iteration cost

Yale Asian American Cultural Center

Aug 2024 – Present

Undergraduate Student Coordinator | Historical, Artistic, and Cultural Resources Team

- Planned and executed large-scale programs (**300+ attendees**) to increase engagement across Yale's pan-Asian population
- Designed and launched a new student arts space, overseeing end-to-end rollout from concept to opening event
- Connected cultural centers, Yale School of Music, School of Art, and artists to deliver collaborative programming

LEADERSHIP/ACTIVITIES

Yale Computer Society

Sep 2025 - Present

- Participated in the Catalyst mentorship program and technical workshops, applying feedback to software projects

Chinese American Students Association

Sep 2023 - Dec 2025

President | Cultural Chair

- Led one of Yale's largest student organizations (**900+ members, \$10K+ budget**), setting direction and coordinating programming across the academic year with a **25-member board**
- Delivered **20+ events per semester**, including large-scale cultural showcases and celebrations (**200+ attendees**)
- Secured corporate and individual sponsorships/collaborations to sustain funding and expand long-term partnerships

Yale Hunger and Homelessness Action Project

Sep 2023 - May 2025

FAST Digital Marketing Lead | Digital Team Designer

- Created the digital strategy for Yale's largest fundraising initiative, **raising \$33K+** for New Haven housing and food insecurity efforts; the creative campaigns drove **2,700+ sign-ups**, the highest participation since pre-COVID

SKILLS

Technical: Jira, Python, R (Shiny), Racket, JavaScript (React, Vite), Mapbox GL JS, Adobe Creative Cloud, Prism, Git

Certifications: Microsoft Office Specialist (Excel, PowerPoint, Word), ACT WorkKeys (Platinum), CITI Program BioSafety

Languages: English (Native), Mandarin Chinese (Intermediate), Spanish (Intermediate), Fuzhou dialect